

Maya Bennett

Integrative relational counselling for adults · Bristol and online

PREPARED BY

Alexander Watson Studio

STAGE

Before website design

STATUS

For your review

DATE

September 2026

The direction of the website is decided here.

A Practice Clarity Blueprint settles the direction of the practice before any design work begins: how the practice is described, who the website should speak to most directly, how it should sound and how it should look. Once it is agreed, the build works from these pages instead of reopening them.

Read it as a description of your practice that you are entitled to correct. Where something is factually wrong, correct it. Where the wording is right but not yours, say that as well — that is an equally useful correction.

UNDERSTANDING THE PRACTICE

01	Practice at a glance
02	Professional identity
03	Philosophy of practice
04	The people you want to reach
05	Messaging and voice
06	Intended client experience

CREATIVE RECOMMENDATION

07	Brand direction
08	Logo and identity
09	Colour
10	Typography
11	Photography and imagery
12	Website translation

SUMMARY AND APPROVAL

13	Practice Clarity Snapshot
14	Approval and next step

Fourteen sections. The first six describe the practice; the next six turn that description into creative direction; the last two summarise it and ask you to approve it.

TO CONFIRM BEFORE PUBLICATION

Qualification and awarding body · Professional register and membership number · Insurer · Supervision arrangement · Consulting-room address and access detail · Current availability · Enquiry email address

These are deliberately blank. Nothing of this kind will appear on the website until you supply it.

HOW TO READ IT

- **Established.** Facts and wording you have given us. Nothing factual has been assumed; anything not yet established is listed at the foot of this page instead of being filled in.
- **Interpretation.** Our reading of what you told us. Most of the first six sections is interpretation, and correcting it is the point of your review.
- **Recommendation.** Proposals for the identity and the website. Approve, adjust or refuse them.

Each page names its section at the top left and the part it belongs to at the top right. The strip at the foot of a page says what the reading there rests on, and how firmly we hold it.

A practice organised around the way people actually arrive.

THE PRACTITIONER

An integrative relational counsellor working in central Bristol and online, five years in independent practice. Arts programming before training — used once, in a sentence, and not sold.

THE PEOPLE

Adults individually. Most often in their twenties, thirties and early forties, frequently new to counselling, and faintly embarrassed to have booked.

THE CENTRAL CONCERN

The distance between having something and being able to say what it is. The practice treats that distance as the ordinary condition people arrive in, rather than as a reason to wait.

THE FEELING TO CREATE

Answered before you have explained yourself properly. Permission that arrives as a reply rather than as reassurance.

Most people start in the middle of a sentence.

THE STATE YOU DESCRIBE PEOPLE ARRIVING IN

WHAT THE PRACTICE IS NOT ORGANISED AROUND

Not a condition list, not a severity threshold, and not a stage of life. The organising fact is the point at which someone gets in touch, and what they are required to have ready when they do.

THE PRACTICAL FACTS

Fee	£60
Session length	50 minutes
Frequency	Weekly, the same time each week
Days	Tuesday to Thursday, 9am–7pm
Delivery	Central Bristol and online across the UK, at the same fee
First conversation	Free, twenty minutes
Reduced fee	Two places, with nothing to prove
Reply time	Within two working days

WHAT THIS RESTS ON

The fee, length, days, delivery and policies you gave us — established. The central concern and the feeling to create are our reading of how you described people arriving, and are the two lines on this page most worth arguing with.

Informal, and entirely deliberate about it.

Present, not neutral

You do not work as a blank screen, and you say so. Someone reading the site should be able to tell that there is a specific person in the room who will react, because an invitation to arrive unedited is only safe if the person receiving it can be read.

Responsive rather than interpretive

You answer the thing a person actually said instead of translating it into a category first. It is the single behaviour most worth designing around, because it is demonstrable on a page in a way that adjectives are not.

Willing to be inconvenient

You would rather say what you notice than agree automatically. This is the least generic thing about the practice, and it should be stated in your own words rather than softened into warmth and honesty.

Unhurried about resolution

Fifty minutes a week with someone who is not in a hurry to fix anybody. Nothing is compulsory, a topic can be declined without a reason, and there is no block of six to commit to.

Plain by decision

Plain words, an ordinary room, no couch and no clipboard. The plainness is a method rather than the absence of one, and the writing should carry it without explaining that it is doing so.

Explicit about limits

Fee, cancellation charge, reply time, availability, access, confidentiality and its two limits, and what the practice is not the fastest help for. Named in the body of the site, in your voice, not in small print.

A counsellor who answers what was actually said, and would rather be inconvenient than agreeable.

IDENTITY STATEMENT · OUR WORDING, FOR YOU TO CORRECT

WHAT WE HAVE NOT CLAIMED

Warm, empathic, safe and non-judgemental appear nowhere in this document. Not because they are untrue of you, but because every practice claims them, none of them can be demonstrated on a page, and none of them tell a designer what to build. Everything above is written so that it can be shown rather than asserted.

Nothing has to be finished to be worked with.

Our reading of the position underneath the modality. It decides what the whole website is organised around, so it is worth disagreeing with if we have it wrong.

Most people believe that therapy begins once they can state the problem: the background in order, when it started, and what they want from it. The practice takes the opposite view. An account arrives incomplete because incomplete is the form the experience is actually in, and waiting for it to resolve is what keeps people out of the room for years at a time.

What makes the incomplete version workable is not the client's insight. It is the response. One incident, one feeling, one contradiction, one recurring argument — each becomes material the moment somebody answers it specifically rather than generally.

Which is why the relationship is treated as evidence rather than as atmosphere. What is easy to say, what gets edited on the way out, what lands and what does not: that is not the preamble to the work.

The untidy version is more useful anyway. It's closer to how you actually think about it.

DEFINING BELIEF, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

WHAT FOLLOWS FROM IT

- Preparation is unnecessary, not unwelcome. What is removed is the requirement, not the tidy account. Someone who arrives with the whole history in order is not doing it wrong.
- A statement is never left standing on its own. Wherever the site shows something a person might bring, it shows what happens to it next.
- Method follows the material rather than the other way round, and the site should say which approaches and why, in one sentence each.
- The client keeps the right to stop — a topic, a session, or the arrangement. That right is stated, not implied.
- Usefulness does not require severity. The threshold is declined out loud rather than quietly relaxed.

WHERE WE HAVE STOPPED SHORT

We have not written that unfinished accounts are truer than finished ones, or that a vague description is better than a clear one. The claim the practice actually makes is narrower and more defensible: the version you have now is enough for the work to start, and the polished version is usually a later draft rather than a more accurate one.

The website should claim the narrower thing. It is more useful and it is easier to keep.

Carrying something that hasn't earned a name yet.

This sets who the website should speak to most directly. It is a question of emphasis in the writing, not a limit on who you will see or a clinical boundary.

VISIBLE FROM OUTSIDE

Work continues. Messages get answered. Nothing looks like an emergency, and to most people they are the competent one. They are good at giving the polished version of themselves, including to themselves.

HAPPENING INSIDE

Something has been sitting there a while. Four years of fine. Saying yes and then resenting it for three days. The same argument with different people. Getting the thing they wanted and feeling almost nothing.

WHAT STOPS THEM ASKING

Not the fee, and mostly not the stigma. The belief that an enquiry has to arrive with a stated problem attached, and a private conviction that somebody else needs the hour more.

WHAT THEY HOPE FOR

To be allowed to start before they understand it, and to find out that the sentence they already have is one that somebody can work with.

TWO TESTS THEY APPLY TO THEMSELVES

The severity test. Is this bad enough to count? It is asked privately, answered no, and it is the largest single reason a first message is never sent. The site has to fail that test out loud, early, and in plain terms — before the reader has invested anything.

The explanation test. Can I say what is actually wrong? Most people cannot, and take that as evidence they are not ready yet. This one cannot be answered by reassurance, because reassurance is exactly what a capable reader discounts. It has to be answered by demonstration.

WHO THIS IS NOT WRITTEN FOR

People in crisis or at immediate risk, who need something faster than counselling and should be told so plainly and early. People looking for a diagnosis, an assessment or a report. People who want a fixed programme with a defined end point.

ON AGE

Most of the people you describe are between their mid-twenties and early forties. We have used that to set reference points and register — the examples, the ordinariness, the humour — and not to draw a boundary. Nothing on the website will state an age range.

WHAT THIS RESTS ON

Your account of who currently gets in touch, and of what they say in the first minute — established. The two tests are our interpretation: they are the mechanism we think keeps this reader out, and most of the website's structure follows from believing them.

Answer first. Explain afterwards.

Whatever you can say now is enough to begin with.

PRIMARY MESSAGE

THREE LINES, THREE JOBS

Positioning

the promise

Whatever you can say now is enough to begin with.

Carries the practice. Used once, near the top, beside the claim it supports.

Recognition

the opening line

Most people start in the middle of a sentence.

An observation rather than a claim, written in the reader’s register. It earns the next thirty seconds; it does not do the persuading.

Permission

at the point of contact

“I’d like to talk to someone” is a complete enquiry.

The promise restated where it has to be believed rather than admired: beside the form, at the moment of hesitation.

HOW IT SHOULD SOUND

Short sentences, ordinary words, and specific detail: Tuesday, three days, four years, an argument you keep replaying. Conversational and a little quick. Willing to be funny without performing lightness — “you can be funny about it, most people are at first” is the level, and it should never reach for more than that.

Second person is used freely, because most of the writing is answering somebody rather than describing them. That is the distinction to hold: the copy replies, it does not characterise the reader or tell them what they feel.

WHY THAT ORDER

The opening line is the better sentence; the second is the better promise. A reader can agree with the first and still do nothing, because it describes them without offering them anything. The line that removes the obstacle is the one about what is enough.

THE ARGUMENT ORDER

Permission, then evidence that the permission is real, then the practical facts, then a way in. Reassurance offered before the demonstration reads as selling; the same sentence after a page of worked examples reads as description.

EMBRACE

- Replies — copy that answers something
- Ordinary specifics: days, sums, minutes
- Half-sentences quoted as people say them
- Method explained in one line each
- Limits named in the body of the page
- Permission without ceremony

AVOID

- Journey, healing, transformation, authentic self
- “You deserve”, “take the first brave step”
- Diagnostic self-description as the way in
- Abstract modality language
- Reassurance with no demonstration behind it
- Any sentence asking the reader to be ready

WHAT THIS RESTS ON

The three lines are yours. Which one carries the positioning is our recommendation, and it is the decision on this page we would most like you to test.

From “I'm not sure this counts” to a message sent.

FEEL	UNDERSTAND	TRUST	DO NEXT
Met before being interpreted. Not embarrassed at having little to say. Allowed to begin somewhere arbitrary, and not asked to perform therapy correctly on the way in.	Within seconds: a counsellor, Bristol and online, adults individually, £60 for fifty minutes, weekly. Then what happens in the room, what integrative and relational actually mean, and that nothing is compulsory.	Built from specifics rather than assurances: ordinary answers to ordinary sentences, published fees and charges, reduced-fee places with nothing to prove, access stated plainly, confidentiality with its limits named, a face that can be read, and a stated willingness not to be the right person.	Send a first message with no description attached. Two working days to a reply, twenty free minutes, then a first session that commits them to nothing once it ends.

THE ARC				
Arrival	Permission	Demonstration	Method	Facts, then contact
The reader's state named in their own register, and one worked example already answered beside it, so the mechanism is legible before anything is asked of them.	The threshold removed explicitly. Nobody has to have a proper reason, and counselling is not only for the worst fortnight of a life.	Sentences people actually say, each with a specific ordinary answer. The reader tests the promise instead of being asked to believe it, and finds out what a session would be like by operating the page.	What happens in fifty minutes, what integrative and relational mean here, and the right to decline a topic.	Everything practical volunteered in order, before it is asked for. Then a short form whose message field is optional and whose hint says one sentence is fine.

STATED IN YOUR OWN VOICE, AS CONTENT RATHER THAN SMALL PRINT

48 hours' notice, and sessions cancelled later are charged · A reply within two working days, and what to do if three pass · Two reduced-fee places, without proof · Ground floor, step-free, accessible toilet · Confidentiality and the two things that limit it · Where to go instead if the need is immediate

Unfinished is allowed. Unresolved is not.

The identity has an unusual job. It has to make an unfinished visitor feel expected without itself looking unfinished. A site that performs informality — hand-drawn marks, scattered type, deliberate roughness — would tell that reader the practice is casual, which is not what the work is, and would cost you exactly the person who is already worried they are not being serious enough.

So the permission comes from what the site says and does. The design's contribution is to be so obviously in order that the invitation reads as competence rather than as a shrug.

Quiet, warm, exactly made. It spends its one moment of visible drama on the only thing that matters: something offered, and something meeting it.

Warm, and completely in order.

DESIGN PRINCIPLE

THREE PRINCIPLES

Offered, then met

Two registers — what a person brings, and what the practice answers — kept visibly apart in type and in colour, and joined only where a meeting actually occurs.

The visitor may be unfinished; the page may not

Nothing is styled to look casual. Where an unfinished thing is shown, it is shown accurately and set with care.

Nothing moves unless the meeting changes

Motion is reserved for a change of state. There is no atmospheric animation anywhere in the system.

WHAT IT CARRIES

- Two registers, kept apart
- Warmth from the palette, not from styling
- One accent, with one meaning
- Ordinary detail at a comfortable size
- Space that reads as unhurried, not sparse

WHAT IT AVOIDS

- Sage, gradients, soft-focus calm
- Rounded cards, drop shadows, icon sets
- Handwriting and scrapbook devices
- Stock photography of tranquillity
- Anything that reads as a wellness brand

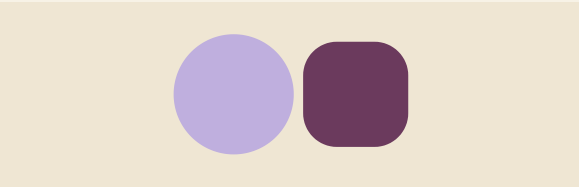
Offered, then met.

A circle and a rounded square. Apart, they are two separate things and there is no overlap: something has been put down, and nothing has happened to it yet. Brought together they intersect — and that intersection is the only place apricot appears anywhere in the system.

Both forms stay themselves throughout. Neither is absorbed and neither is corrected, and the third shape exists only while both are present. That is the claim the practice makes about an hour, drawn once.

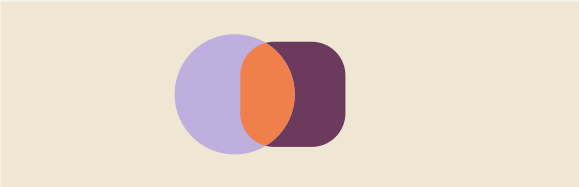
- CONSTRUCTION
- Two forms on one axis. The distance between them is the only variable
 - Offered: 34 units apart in a 150-unit drawing. Met: zero
 - The overlap is apricot at full strength, clipped to the circle — never tinted, never outlined
 - Clear space one circle radius on all four sides; minimum 30px wide, and below that the met state only
 - Never rotated, boxed, gradiented, or placed on a photograph

OFFERED



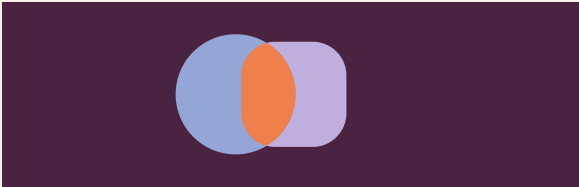
Beside a sentence put forward and not yet answered. This state never appears in the identity itself — only in content.

MET



The identity state. Wordmark, favicon, touch icon, correspondence, and any sentence that has been answered.

ON PLUM



On dark grounds the circle takes blue and the square takes lilac. The overlap does not change: apricot is apricot everywhere.

PRIMARY LOCKUP



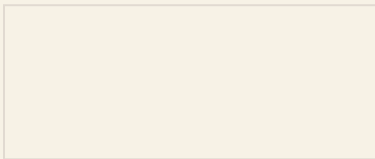
The name in Fraunces — identity rather than voice, and the single exception to the type rule. The descriptor is always set in the grotesque.

MOTION — NOTHING MOVES UNLESS THE MEETING CHANGES

WHERE	WHAT	DURATION	REDUCED MOTION	WITHOUT SCRIPT	NEVER ANIMATES
The mark, and only when an offered sentence is answered.	The separation closes to zero. The apricot appears as a consequence, never on its own.	500ms, one eased transition. No stagger and no delay.	The same composition, arrived at instantly. Nothing disabled or hidden.	Every sentence is already met, and the page is complete.	Photographs, sections, fragments, the wordmark, anything on scroll.

The one rule. The mark appears only where the distinction is true: on a sentence that can be met, on the worked example, and in the wordmark. It is not an eyebrow bullet, a list marker, a divider or a decoration — used where nothing is being met, it stops meaning anything, and the site loses its only piece of argument that works without words.

One colour carries the argument.



Paper

#F7F2E6 deep #EFE6D3

THE GROUND

A warm off-white for everything that is read. The deeper shade separates one section from the next without a border.

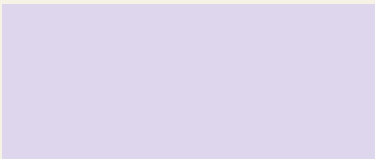


Plum

#4A2340 ink #2A1626 mid #6B3A5D

GROUND AND TEXT

All primary type on paper, and the full-bleed ground where the practice describes what it does. Mid-plum is the quieter voice: labels, captions, notes.



Lilac

#DED6EC deep #BFAFDE

THE TIDY VERSION

Stands for something nobody has to bring: the composed account, drawn as uniform bars. Deep lilac is one of the two forms of the mark.



Apricot

#EF7F4B at text weight #A6461F

MET

Two appearances only: the overlap in the mark, and the short rule that introduces a reply. A shape colour rather than a text colour; where it must be read as type it darkens.



Blue

#38538F soft #93A6D6

LINKS AND FOCUS, ON LIGHT

Interaction on paper: links, and a focus ring that is never removed. Soft blue exists only as the circle of the mark on dark grounds.



Butter

#F6C95C

LINKS AND FOCUS, ON PLUM

The same job as blue, on the dark sections, where blue would not separate from the ground. An interaction colour, never a highlight.

THE RULE THAT PROTECTS THE ACCENT

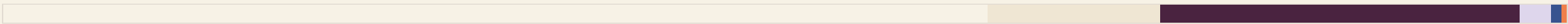
Apricot means one thing: the moment something is met. Two places, and nowhere else. Not on buttons, navigation, section rules, borders, dots, step numbers, card fills or icons, and not on a heading that happens to need lifting. Each additional use is small; the total cost is the only colour on the site that makes an argument by itself.

If a page feels flat, the answer is space or a change of ground, not a second accent.

CONTRAST AND PAIRING

Every pairing clears WCAG AA against the ground it is actually painted on, not against white. Body text is plum-ink on paper and paper on plum; mid-plum is used for secondary text on light grounds only. Focus is visible in both directions — blue on light, butter on plum — and is never suppressed for tidiness.

PROPORTION ON ANY SCREEN



Paper 63 Paper deep 11 Plum 23 Lilac 2 Blue and butter 0.7 Apricot 0.3

A face for the sentence. A face for the reply.

FRAUNCES · WHAT IS BROUGHT

Aa I can’t tell if I’m unhappy.

A variable serif with its softness and wonk axes raised. It gives an offered sentence a provisional look — something said rather than something inscribed. Weights 400 and 500 only.

HIERARCHY

Opening statement	Fraunces 400 · 40–80px · SOFT 80	Most people start in the middle
Offered sentence	Fraunces 400 · 16–18px · SOFT 70	“I’ve been fine for four years.”
Reply	Hanken 400 · matches the sentence	I’d ask what fine has involved.
Section claim	Hanken 500 · 22–54px · –.022em	You don’t need to prepare.
Body	Hanken 400 · 16–18px · 1.6	The untidy version is more useful.
Ledger and data	Hanken 500 · tabular figures	£60 · 50 minutes · weekly
Label	Hanken 600 · 11–12px · .12em caps	FEES & PRACTICAL
Wordmark	Fraunces 500 · SOFT 60 · the exception	Maya Bennett

NOT USED A third typeface · italic, which neither family has drawn and neither is obliqued into · letterspaced or all-capital serif · the serif for any fact, fee, time or form label

HANKEN GROTESK · WHAT IS SAID BACK

£60 50 min Tue–Thu

A plain grotesque, deliberately unremarkable. It carries every reply, every claim, every fact, the ledger, the form and the small print. Weights 400, 500 and 600; tabular figures throughout.

THE RULE

Not serif for feeling and sans for fact. Fraunces carries material offered into the room: the opening statement of the reader’s own position, the sentences people say, the fragments. Hanken carries the practice’s side of the exchange. Kept apart, the two registers do the explaining, and nobody has to be told what the site is doing.

THE EQUALITY

A sentence and its reply are set at the same size, in the same measure, with the same weight of colour. The answer never outranks the thing being brought, and this is the one rule not relaxed for layout: set a reply larger and the page has told somebody that what the practice says matters more than what they came with.

ON A PHONE, AND IN THIS DOCUMENT

Both registers stay between 16 and 18px; the opening statement falls to 40px and no further, and a reply opens directly beneath its sentence. The same division is used in these pages — anything offered for you to correct is set in the serif, anything we are specifying is in the grotesque.

Two photographs, each answering a question.

Photography here is evidence rather than atmosphere. Each image exists because a specific question is being asked by somebody who has not decided yet, and neither can be answered in words.

TREATMENT

- Daylight from one direction, with visible shadow. Nothing lit or graded to look calm
- Available light only, no styling, no props introduced for the shoot
- Square corners, no vignette, no overlay, never behind text
- Room 4:3, portrait 4:5. Two sources each, so neither is soft on a good screen nor upscaled
- Each appears once, at a moderate size, captioned in the practice’s own voice

HOW MANY

Two is the specification, not a starting point. A third photograph would have to answer a question the copy raises and cannot settle itself. Filling the page is not such a question.

NOT PHOTOGRAPHED

A notebook and a sharpened pencil · hands around a mug · tissues, candles, pebbles · window-light abstracts · plants · Bristol as scenery · anything staged to resemble a session · a laughing practitioner · stock images of calm

The first of those is the standard image for a practice like this one, and it argues against the page it would sit on: a blank sheet waiting to be filled, beside copy that says you do not need to prepare.



The room. Answers: what kind of place would I be sitting in? An ordinary room with good light and a door that shuts — not a clinic and not a consulting room. The chairs are turned slightly away from one another, and the caption carries the reason: nobody has to look straight at anybody.



The portrait. Answers: who receives the thing I bring? Close, at eye level, direct to camera, in daylight. An invitation to arrive unedited is only safe if the person receiving it can be read.

What the website has to do.

Every requirement follows from a conclusion on an earlier page. If a conclusion changes when you review it, the requirement beside it changes with it.

STRATEGIC CONCLUSION

DESIGN REQUIREMENT

Permission is worthless unless it is demonstrated, so the mechanism has to be visible before anything is asked.

The first screen carries the opening statement, the practical facts — adults individually, £60 per fifty minutes, Bristol or online — and one worked example already answered: a sentence, and the reply to it. What happens to an unfinished thing is legible before the reader has scrolled.

The severity test is asked privately and answered no.

A short section immediately after the first screen that removes the threshold in plain terms, including that counselling is not only for the worst fortnight of a life. A section of its own, on the way in — not a line in an FAQ and not a reassurance in the footer.

The requirement to prepare is what stops the message being sent.

"You don't need to prepare" is a major section with an argument in it: what people believe they have to bring, set beside what is genuinely enough. Two columns, shown rather than described — the imagined requirement uniform and composed, the real thing in the visitor's own half-sentences.

The claim has to be testable by the reader rather than believed.

A set of things people actually say, each with a specific ordinary answer. Built on native disclosure behaviour: keyboard and screen-reader support standard, every row in the tab order, no invented ARIA, and every answer present with the script switched off.

People still search in plain categories, and recognising a word is not the same as being addressed by it.

A recognition index — anxiety, self-esteem, people-pleasing, endings, burnout, family patterns — placed after the demonstration and set as an aside. It exists for search and for recognition. It never becomes the site's account of who the practice is for.

Method should be described rather than asserted, in the same plain register as everything else.

One section on sessions: fifty minutes, weekly, the same time; what actually happens in the hour; integrative in a sentence and relational in a sentence; and the right to decline a topic, stated as a right.

An invitation to arrive unedited is safer when the person receiving it can be read.

A section about the practitioner in the first person, with the portrait, and a position stated rather than a biography listed: not a blank screen, will not tell you how to live, will say what she notices even when it is inconvenient.

STRATEGIC CONCLUSION

Volunteering the awkward fact is how this practice earns trust.

The obstacle is commitment as much as description.

The enquiry must be completable by somebody who has nothing to say yet.

The reader most likely to need this is on a phone, late, and not sitting down to research.

Nothing may suggest that the visitor should already be certain.

DESIGN REQUIREMENT

Everything practical published as content: fee, length, availability, first call, payment, the cancellation charge, two reduced-fee places with nothing to prove, step-free access, confidentiality and the two things that limit it, and the reply time. In the body of the page, in the practice's voice. No small print anywhere on the site.

Three reversible steps — a message, a short call, a first session — with the right to stop after any one of them stated in the heading rather than implied. No block of six, no package, no minimum.

Name, email, a format choice with "not sure yet" available and selected by default, and an optional message whose hint says one sentence is fine. Beside it, one line: "I'd like to talk to someone" is a complete enquiry. Errors are written in the same voice as the rest of the page.

Below the breakpoint the reply opens directly beneath its sentence, where the thumb already is. Fee, contact and the enquiry reachable without hunting; targets at 44px; nothing that depends on hover; and the whole argument still legible in a single column.

Deliberate omissions: no testimonials, no outcome claims or guarantees, no countdown, no lead magnet, no quiz, no funnel, no booking-pressure language, no second competing call to action, and no animation that is not a change of state.

PAGE ORDER

- 01 Arrival
- 02 No threshold
- 03 You don't need to prepare
- 04 Sentences, answered
- 05 Search words, as an aside
- 06 What sessions are like
- 07 Maya
- 08 Fees and practical
- 09 Three steps
- 10 Enquire

One page, no sub-pages. Four items of navigation and one action, so the site never asks the reader to choose a route through it. The order is the argument: permission, demonstration, method, person, facts, way in.

STANDARDS THE BUILD IS HELD TO

- Complete and usable with JavaScript unavailable
- WCAG AA against every painted ground; focus always visible
- Reduced motion honoured without removing function
- Type and images self-hosted; no third party sees a visitor's address

One page to hold the build against.

PROFESSIONAL IDENTITY

An integrative relational counsellor who is informal and entirely deliberate about it: present rather than neutral, willing to say what she notices, and explicit about what things cost and where they stop.

PHILOSOPHY

Nothing has to be finished to be worked with. What makes an incomplete account useful is not the client's insight but a specific response to it.

PEOPLE TO REACH

Adults who are functioning, carrying something long-standing, and privately convinced it is neither serious enough nor explainable enough to bring to anyone.

VOICE

Plain, quick, ordinary. Answers rather than describes. Funny where that is natural, never solemn, and permissive without reassuring.

DESIRED FEELING

Answered before you have explained yourself properly.

CORE MESSAGE

Whatever you can say now is enough to begin with.

IDENTITY IDEA



Offered, then met. Two forms that keep their own shape, and an overlap that exists only while both are present.

VISUAL DIRECTION

Paper and plum, lilac for the tidy version, apricot for meeting and for nothing else. Fraunces for what is brought, Hanken Grotesk for what is said. Two photographs. Motion only where a meeting changes.

WEBSITE PRIORITY

Make it possible to enquire before the visitor has turned what is happening to them into a story.

THE ONE TEST

— Somebody who cannot yet say what is wrong should be able to send a message that is complete.

Does this sound like your practice?

Once you approve it, this Blueprint is the agreed direction for the website. The build then works from these pages, so the time goes into making the site good instead of settling the same questions twice.

Read it once quickly and once slowly. Where something is factually wrong, correct it. Where something is right but badly put, say so — that is an equally useful correction. Where you disagree with a recommendation, say what you would want instead, or simply say it isn't you, and we will find the version that is.

One consolidated round of revision is included at this stage. Sending your comments together produces a better document and a faster build.

WHAT TO REVIEW

- The practical facts, and the details still to confirm
- Whether the professional identity sounds like you
- The philosophy on page 05, and whether we have overstated it
- Who the site speaks to most directly
- Which of the three lines carries the practice
- The voice, and the things it declines to say
- The mark, and what it is allowed to mean
- Colour, and the single job apricot is given
- Typography, and the two registers it keeps apart
- Photography, and what you are willing to be photographed doing
- The interaction, and whether you would answer those sentences that way
- The website requirements on pages 14 and 15

AFTER APPROVAL

Design begins from the direction agreed here, so the website can go into bringing it to life instead of reopening the same decisions. Anything still listed as to be confirmed is collected before publication, not before design.



Maya Bennett

Prepared by Alexander Watson Studio · alexanderwatson.co.uk